

*ICA 2022 Preconference “Understanding the Dynamics of
(Ir)Responsible AI in Journalism and Algorithmically
Shaped News Flows”*

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When AI Selects Political News: Algorithmic Content Curation and Party Plurality

Procurement → Production → Distribution → Consumption

News Value Chain

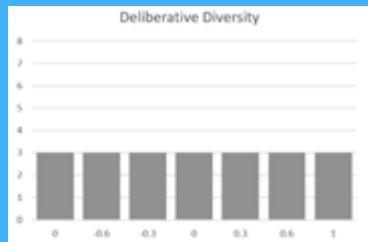
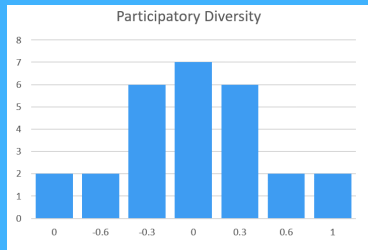


Procurement → Production → Distribution → Consumption

News Value Chain

- News party **visibility** might affect party **preferences** (Eberl, Boomgaarden, & Wagner, 2017; Geers & Bos, 2017; Hopmann et al., 2010)
- We can differentiate (at least) three **visibility regimes** in public spheres (Helberger, 2019)

Starting Points



What are effects of varying party visibilities in personalized political news recommendations on party preferences?



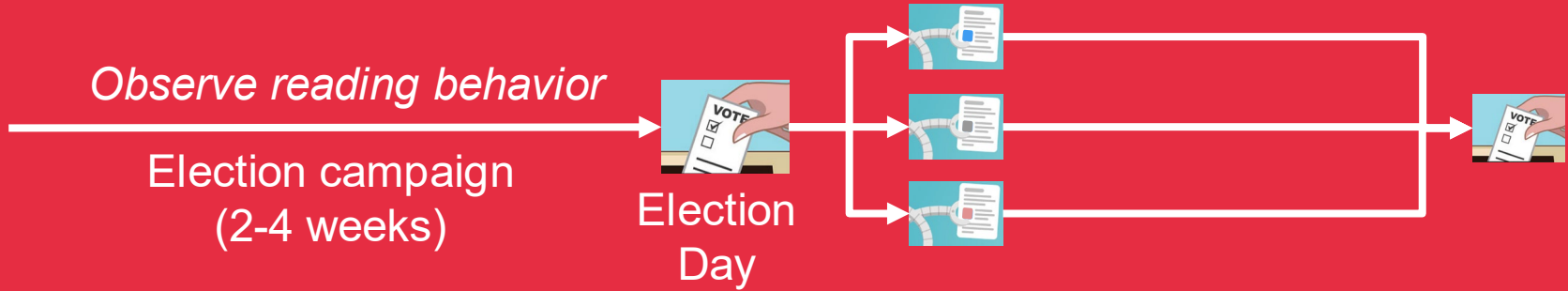
RQ

1. News **app** aggregates articles in real-time
2. Political parties are identified using **named entity recognition** in each article
3. Recommender creates **visibility** regimes
4. Participants **use** the news app during election

Study Design



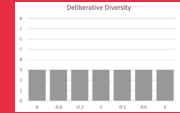
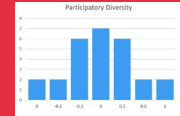
A. Avoid manipulation of real-world election results



(Ir)responsibility Challenges

B. Incumbent party visibility will be “natural” news condition (Hopmann et al., 2011)

- Deliberative condition = reducing information
- Feasibility of critical model unlikely



(Ir)responsibility Challenges

B. Incumbent party visibility will be “natural” news condition (Hopmann et al., 2011)

→ Incumbent party varies per state:

- Lower Saxony: Social Democratic Party (SPD)
- Bavaria: Christian Social Union (CSU)
- Saxony: AfD (“Alternative for Germany”)



(Ir)responsibility Challenges

- We need to understand effects of automated news recommendations on party preferences
- Experimental design could do it in principle
- Negotiating ethical challenges with potential findings unclear

Bottom Line

Outlook: Founding of an interdisciplinary research group
("DFG Forschungsgruppe")

→ We're in the stage of searching for **project partners** 🙏

Ideas very welcome!

Thank you!